

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X

JAMANE HEROD,

Plaintiff,

-against-

SUMMONS

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
MATTHEW MCCURRY, Shield No. 20597, POLICE
OFFICER PATRICK CHILTON, Shield No. 4779, and
SERGEANT MICHAEL HANSSON, Shield No. 2972, and
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE
THROUGH TEN,

Index No.:

The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Plaintiff designates KINGS
County as the place of trial.

Defendants.

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To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
September 17, 2020

Yours, etc.

/s/

JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP.
STUART E. JACOBS, ESQ.
Attorney for Plaintiff
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007
(212) 577-2690

TO: City of New York, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
POLICE OFFICER MATTHEW MCCURRY, Shield No. 20597, 75th Precinct, 1000
Sutter Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11208
POLICE OFFICER PATRICK CHILTON, Shield No. 4779, 75th Precinct, 1000 Sutter
Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11208
SERGEANT MICHAEL HANSSON, Shield No. 2972, 75th Precinct, 1000 Sutter Ave,
Brooklyn, NY 11208

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

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JAMANE HEROD,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER
MATTHEW MCCURRY, Shield No. 20597, POLICE
OFFICER PATRICK CHILTON, Shield No. 4779, and
SERGEANT MICHAEL HANSSON, Shield No. 2972, and
POLICE OFFICERS JOHN DOES NUMBERS ONE
THROUGH TEN,

Defendants.

----- X

INDEX NO.:

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

JURY TRIAL DEMANDED

Plaintiff JAMANE HEROD, by his attorneys, Jacobs & Hazan, LLP, as and for his
Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of
defendants' violation of plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C.
Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth
Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State
of New York. On July 5, 2018, at approximately 12:15 a.m., plaintiff while a lawful passenger
in a motor vehicle traveling in the vicinity of Hegeman Avenue and Vermont Street, Brooklyn,
New York was subjected to a false arrest and false imprisonment by the defendant New York
City police officers. Thereafter, plaintiff was subjected to a malicious prosecution and was
denied the right to due process and a fair trial by the defendant police officers until all charges
were dismissed on December 27, 2018. Plaintiff was deprived of his constitutional and
common law rights when the individual defendants unlawfully searched, confined, falsely
arrested, falsely imprisoned, maliciously prosecuted, and denied plaintiff the right to due
process and a fair trial in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the
United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York

PARTIES

2. Plaintiff JAMANE HEROD is a resident of the state of New York.

3. Defendant POLICE OFFICER MATTHEW MCCURRY, Shield No. 20597, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

4. Defendant POLICE OFFICER MATTHEW MCCURRY, Shield No. 20597, is and was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 75th Precinct.

5. Defendant POLICE OFFICER MATTHEW MCCURRY, Shield No. 20597, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

6. Defendant POLICE OFFICER PATRICK CHILTON, Shield No. 4779, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

7. Defendant POLICE OFFICER PATRICK CHILTON, Shield No. 4779, is and was at all times relevant herein, assigned to the 75th Precinct.

8. Defendant POLICE OFFICER PATRICK CHILTON, Shield No. 4779, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

9. Defendant SERGEANT MICHAEL HANSSON, Shield No. 2972, is and was at all times relevant herein, an officer, employee, and agent of the New York City Police Department.

10. Defendant SERGEANT MICHAEL HANSSON, Shield No. 2972, is and was at all times relevant herein, assigned to 75th precinct.

11. Defendant SERGEANT MICHAEL HANSSON, Shield No. 2972, is being sued in his individual and official capacity.

12. Defendant New York City Police Officers John Does #s 1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.

13. Defendant Police Officers John Does #s 1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.

14. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

15. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. Defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

16. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the CITY OF NEW YORK in compliance with the General Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

17. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on April 9, 2019.

18. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and THE CITY OF NEW YORK has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

19. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

20. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

21. Pursuant to NYS Executive Orders 202.8, 202.14, 202.28, 202.38, 202.48, 202.55, and 202.60 duly executed by NYS Governor Andrew Cuomo related to the COVID-19 health crisis, all claims filed herein are deemed timely filed.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

22. On July 5, 2018, at approximately 12:15 a.m., plaintiff was a lawful passenger in a motor vehicle traveling in the vicinity of Hegeman Avenue and Vermont Street, Brooklyn, New York when the defendant police officers unlawfully stopped the motor vehicle and unlawfully handcuffed and falsely arrested plaintiff without reasonable suspicion or probable cause.

23. The defendant officers ordered plaintiff to get out of the vehicle and proceeded to search the vehicle without legal justification or probable cause.

24. At no point relevant herein did the defendant police officers recover any drugs, weapons or other contraband from plaintiff or from plaintiff's possession, custody or control.

25. At no time relevant herein did plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law, nor did plaintiff behave in a manner that would lead a reasonable police officer to believe that plaintiff committed, was about to commit or was committing a crime.

26. Nevertheless, plaintiff was unlawfully handcuffed and unlawfully arrested plaintiff by the defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause.

27. Plaintiff was transported by the defendant police officers to the 75th precinct against his will, where he was photographed, searched, fingerprinted and then placed in a holding cell by the defendants.

28. Thereafter, the defendant police officers conducted an invasive and unlawful strip search of plaintiff without reasonable suspicion or probable cause.

29. Specifically, plaintiff was forced to take off all of his clothes and shake each piece of clothing out.

30. Plaintiff was then ordered to turn around, and with his back facing the defendant police officers, plaintiff was forced to bend over and spread his buttocks and lift his genitals.

31. Notably, at no time did the defendant police officers recover any drugs, contraband or other illegal paraphernalia from plaintiff.

32. After several hours in unlawful custody, plaintiff was transported from the 75th Precinct to Brooklyn County Central Booking.

33. The defendant police officers provided the District Attorney's Office with false, misleading and/or incomplete information about the facts that allegedly led them to believe that plaintiff committed a crime.

34. Based upon the false, misleading and/or incomplete information provided to the District Attorney's Office by the defendant police officers, a prosecution was initiated against plaintiff.

35. Specifically, the defendant police officers falsely state to the District Attorney's Office that plaintiff was in possession of a firearm, when in fact the defendant police officers knew that plaintiff was not in possession, custody, or control of a firearm.

36. On July 6, 2018, at approximately 3:00 pm, after being unlawfully detained for approximately 40 hours, plaintiff was arraigned in Brooklyn Criminal Court, charged with crimes he did not commit and for which the defendant police officers had no legal justification to accuse him of committing, and plaintiff was released on his own recognizance.

37. Plaintiff was charged with Criminal Possession of a Weapon in the Fourth Degree, amongst other charges.

38. Thereafter, plaintiff was forced to appear in Court on two further occasions before all charges were dismissed and sealed on December 27, 2018.

39. As a result of the false arrest and malicious prosecution, plaintiff was unable to obtain employment and therefore suffered lost wages.

40. As a result of the unlawful arrest and malicious prosecution, plaintiff's motor vehicle was seized and he was forced to spend money on Uber's for several months until he finally got his car back.

41. Some of the police officer defendants observed the violation of plaintiff's rights under the Constitution of the United States and New York State Law and did nothing to prevent the unjustifiable seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, illegal strip search, denial of the right to a fair trial, and malicious prosecution of plaintiff.

42. The seizure, false arrest and imprisonment, illegal strip search, denial of the right to a fair trial, and malicious prosecution of plaintiff by the individually named defendants caused plaintiff to sustain physical, psychological and emotional trauma.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Plaintiff's Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights

43. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 42 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

44. The individually named police officer defendants while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused plaintiff to be seized, unlawfully searched, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, maliciously prosecuted, and denied the right to a fair trial without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

45. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional, psychological and economic injuries.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

False Arrest and False Imprisonment

46. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 45 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

47. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine plaintiff and, in fact, confined plaintiff, and plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

48. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

49. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

50. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

51. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search

52. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 51 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

53. The illegal approach, pursuit, stop and search employed by defendants herein terminated plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

54. Defendants lacked probable cause to search plaintiff.

55. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

56. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

57. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

58. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Malicious Prosecution

59. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 58 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

60. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the laws of the United States Constitution, State of New York and New York State common law.

61. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against plaintiff.

62. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against plaintiff and for each of the charges for which she was prosecuted.

63. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned date.

64. Plaintiff was subjected to a post-arraignment deprivation of liberty sufficient to implicate plaintiff's Fourth Amendment rights.

65. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

66. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

67. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Denial of Right to Fair Trial

68. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 67 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein

69. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Brooklyn District Attorney's Office.

70. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the District Attorney's Office.

71. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the District Attorney's Office.

72. In withholding/creating false evidence against plaintiff Jamane Herod and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, defendants violated plaintiff's constitutional right to a fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.

73. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff Jamane Herod, sustained, inter alia, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, lost earnings and deprivation of her constitutional rights.

74. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

75. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

76. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

77. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 76 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

78. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to plaintiff, Jamane Herod. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

79. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to plaintiff and violated plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

80. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

81. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

82. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

83. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

84. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 83 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

85. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants, individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

86. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Strip Search

87. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 86 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

88. Plaintiff was searched by defendants without an individualized reasonable suspicion that plaintiff was concealing weapons or other contraband based on a crime charged, the particular characteristics of the arrestee, and/or the circumstances of the arrest.

89. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff's Constitutional rights were deprived and he sustained great emotional injuries.

90. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the United States Constitution and the State of New York.

91. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene

92. The plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in paragraphs marked 1 through 91 with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

93. The defendants that did not physically touch plaintiff, but were present when other officers violated plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

94. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

95. As a result of the foregoing, plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, she was put in fear of her safety, and she was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

96. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived plaintiff of her rights under the laws of the State of New York.

97. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

98. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

99. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

JURY DEMAND

100. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, plaintiff Jamane Herod demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law. That the plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988.

Dated: New York, New York
September 17, 2020

By: /s/
STUART E. JACOBS, ESQ.
JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP
Attorneys for Plaintiff
30 Vesey Street, 4th Floor
New York, NY 10007
(212) 577-2690

TO: City of New York, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007
POLICE OFFICER MATTHEW MCCURRY, Shield No. 20597, 75th Precinct, 1000 Sutter Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11208
POLICE OFFICER PATRICK CHILTON, Shield No. 4779, 75th Precinct, 1000 Sutter Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11208
SERGEANT MICHAEL HANSSON, Shield No. 2972, 75th Precinct, 1000 Sutter Ave, Brooklyn, NY 11208

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

STUART E. JACOBS, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am a partner of the law firm of **JACOBS & HAZAN, LLP**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
September 17, 2020

/s/
STUART E. JACOBS, ESQ.